

Key Enablers of Success

Culture of collaboration
CFT engagement

Agile project management
Planning

Continuous training and upskilling
Update to current trend

Strong supplier partnerships
Nearshore

Closed-loop feedback from manufacturing to design
Lessons learned

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a support function into a competitive differentiator. Charging infrastructure, battery supply, component sourcing, and electronics procurement have all become strategic priorities.

To build resilience, companies are diversifying suppliers, reducing dependence on single-source vendors, adopting supply chain platforms for real-time visibility, investing in IoT-based warehouse monitoring, and exploring near-shoring strategies. The recent disruptions in the Red Sea highlighted the need for more localised and decentralised procurement models.

What makes NPI successful today

Having worked through numerous NPI cycles, I have found that several factors consistently contribute to success.

- There must be a culture of teamwork. Car products cannot be developed in silos.
- Project management should combine agile methods with structured, milestone-based planning. Neither waterfall nor agile alone is sufficient. The right balance between the two enables teams to remain flexible without losing direction.
- Continuous upskilling is no longer optional. The industry is evolving faster than our knowledge can keep pace.
- Closed-loop feedback mechanisms and strong supplier

relationships help teams improve with every product launch.

- Most importantly, customer needs deserve the same level of attention as regulatory compliance. Both are non-negotiable in the automotive industry.

I have also seen many start-ups fail to move into production despite having excellent designs. The reason is almost always the same: they underestimate the importance of process discipline. In automotive manufacturing, there are no shortcuts. You cannot skip a stage of the process. You can only accelerate it.

The road ahead

We are living in a period of unprecedented disruption, where electric vehicles, hybrids, and internal combustion engine vehicles are all evolving rapidly. The companies that succeed will not necessarily be the largest. They will be the fastest to innovate and execute.

When we think ahead, test continuously, collaborate deeply, adopt digital tools, and analyse risks with rigour, we can deliver outstanding products consistently. That is the future of automotive NPI—and it has already arrived. **EFY**

The article is based on a talk delivered at the EFY Expo in Pune titled 'Solving Challenges with New Product Introduction and Manufacturing in the Automotive Sector,' featuring the opening address by Vijay Aditya Raghavan, VP, TVS Electronics Limited. It has been transcribed and curated by Vidushi Saxena, journalist at EFY until recently.

Once you stop learning, you start dying.

—Albert Einstein

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